



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

tato* nivṛttaḥ sa* nivṛtta+harṣaḥ |
pradhāna+yuktaḥ praviveśa (veśma Cśadma) |
taṃ* dviś* tathā prekṣya ca saṃnivṛttaṃ* |
(paryeṣaṇaṃ* Cpury* āgamaṃ*)bhūmi+patiś* cakāra || 3.48 |
śrutvā nimittaṃ* tu nivartanasya |
saṃtyaktam ātmānam anena mene |
mārgasya śauca+adhikṛtāya ca*eva |
cukrośa ruṣṭo* *api ca na*ugra+daṇḍaḥ || 3.49 |

— Buddhacarita, Chapter 3, Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

Having turned away from the allure of the world, Siddhartha, his joy diminished, entered his private chambers, deeply absorbed in meditation. The king, his father, observing his son's changed demeanor and retreat, initiated inquiries into the cause of his withdrawal. Upon learning the reason for Siddhartha's detachment, the king felt as though his own self had been renounced. He summoned those responsible for ensuring the purity of the path, expressing his displeasure, yet refrained from harsh punishment.

This passage speaks to the profound inner transformation Siddhartha underwent, a turning away from worldly pleasures toward a deeper spiritual quest. It highlights the initial detachment from superficial joy, replaced by the focused intensity of meditation. This resonates with your own journey, as you may experience moments where the fleeting pleasures of life lose their appeal, prompting a search for something more substantial.

The king's reaction reveals the attachments and fears that bind us. He sees Siddhartha's renunciation as a personal rejection, demonstrating how easily we project our own desires and expectations onto others. This is a common human experience. You might find yourself resisting changes in loved ones, clinging to how you perceive them rather than accepting their individual paths.

The king's restrained anger serves as a reminder to approach challenging situations with compassion and understanding, even when feeling hurt or disappointed. He could have unleashed his fury, but he chose a more measured response. In your own life, consider how you can cultivate this mindful restraint, responding to conflict with wisdom rather than immediate emotional reaction. Siddhartha's path inspires us to examine our attachments, embrace introspection, and act with thoughtful compassion, even in the face of personal disappointment. He exemplifies the courage to pursue inner truth, regardless of external pressures or expectations.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

Are you willing to let go of your expectations of others, allowing them to pursue their own paths, even if it means diverging from your own desires for them?